

pulse ■ letters

Write again

Dear Vinit,
I am a regular reader of Digit since February 1999 and have found that it is the best PC technology magazine in India. I have an LG 6080B 5x-24x2x CD-Writer and am quite satisfied with its performance. But since there are much faster drives available in the market nowadays, I'm planning to purchase a new drive. I've heard rumours that CDs written at such high speeds on these new drives are not recognised by some CD-ROM drives and home audio systems. Can you do a comparison test for CD-Writer's once again?

Nishant Mehta
Via e-mail

Dear Nishant,

We're aware that the technology for CD-writers is evolving rather rapidly with faster drives being released ever so often. This reminds us of the mid-1990s where we witnessed a similar trend with CD-ROM drives, but now the CD-ROM is something we take for granted just like the ubiquitous floppy drive. For this very reason we're carrying an addendum to our February 2002 CD-Writer shootout this month. Turn to page 56 for a spanking new CD-Writer shootout, but be warned, there are a few surprises along the way!

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Working@Home

Dear Sir,
I've seen many ads in national newspapers proclaiming "Work for 2-3 hours from home and make money on the Net". I've personally contacted quite a few such advertisers and found that they simply charge Rs 600 to Rs 1,200 to give you a list of Web sites where you can make money. Could you evaluate some of these Web sites by registering and testing their services? I'm sure there would be many readers like me who would be interested in knowing about the authenticity of these sites and whether they match up to their claims.

Mrs Kinnariben
Via e-mail

Dear Mrs Kinnariben,

Sounds like an interesting story. We'll definitely explore the possibility of carrying it in an upcoming issue. In the meantime, you could check out a similar article we've carried in our February 2002 issue titled 'Make Your PC an Earning Member'. This article is also featured at www.thinkdigit.com/connect/firsthand/stories/38586.html.

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Written artefacts

Dear Vinit,
I know this letter is late, but as they say, better late than never. The article on 3D chips in the August 2002 issue is mediocre. Even though you have explained about Pixel & Vertex Shaders and the gaming realism they provide, you have failed to mention that these features are absent in GeForce4 MX chips as well as the older GeForce2 Ti MX chips. Additionally, calling the game CPU sensitive then calling the CPU the system bottleneck (Coma test, page 69) are one and the same thing—in both cases CPU scaling is the only solution.

Alston Fernandes
Via e-mail

Dear Alston,

You've made some astute observations. The fact that the chipsets don't have DirectX 8.1 features (namely vertex/pixel shader) has been clearly mentioned in the Graphics Chipsets at a Glance table on Page 72-73. As far as your comment about Coma concerned, a CPU-sensitive game engine is not quite the same as system processor being a bottleneck. A CPU-sensitive engine is not offload rendering tasks to the GPU as next-generation engines do. Because we don't know the internal functioning of Coma's rendering engine, we can only make an observation: you will find that the poor performance of the graphics chips are used to either a CPU-sensitive game engine or a slow processor test system. The solution, as you rightly pointed out, is the same in both cases: CPU scaling, but the cause can be either.

Linux is your karma

Hi Guys,
You keep talking about software piracy, but do little to promote Linux, the most practical alternative to Windows. I think you owe it to your readers to introduce Linux distributions on a regular basis. You could do a special subscription scheme at a higher price where you increase the number of CDs to three and use the additional CD to provide regular Linux software and new distributions. Or you could add a third Linux CD with 20 per cent of your newsstand copies and charge a slight premium over your regular cover price to recover the increased production costs.

Amit Kumar
Via e-mail

Hi Amit,

Your suggestions have some merit but doing this as a regular exercise is something that would need careful thought and research as we're not too sure how many of our readers would be willing to pay extra for their Linux fix every month. That we'll continue to offer newer Linux distributions at periodic intervals similar to the Mandrake 8.2 CD we bundled with our 2002 anniversary issue.

Your vote counts

Q. What type of interface would you prefer on the Digit CDs?

HTML	Director	Doesn't matter
49%	33%	18%

Watch out for a cool new HTML interface from January 2003!

This month's question:

"What do you think about Digit's unique half-flap covers?"

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote